

PAINTING IN STAGES

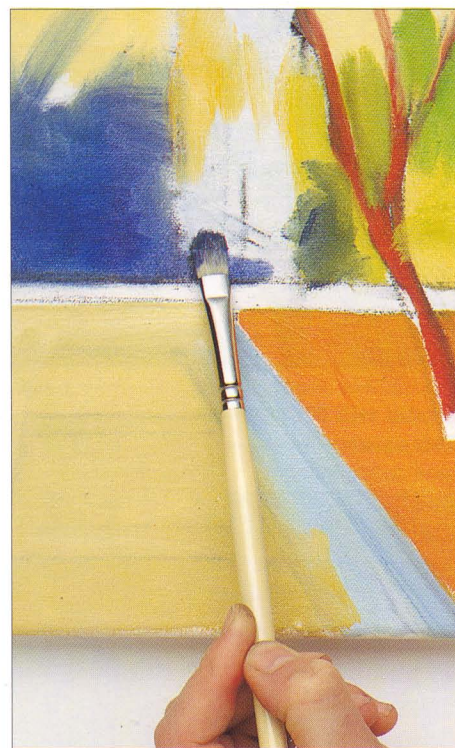
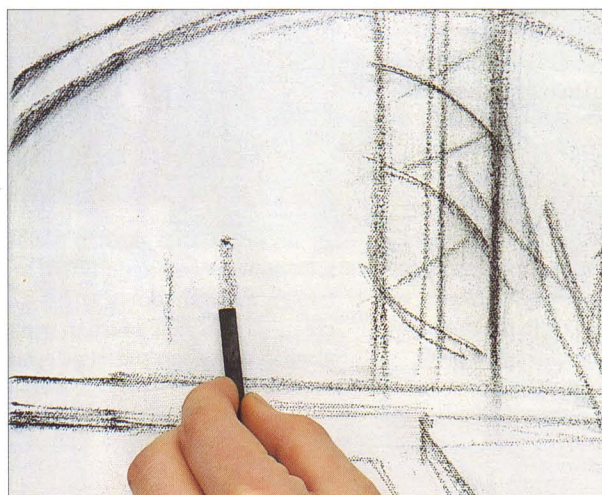


*Preparatory sketch
from life*

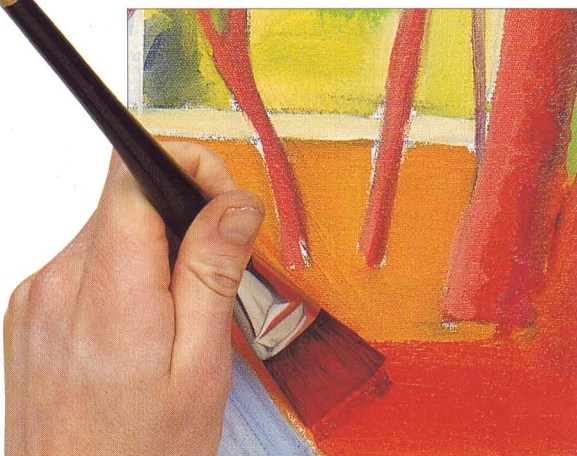
THERE IS OFTEN an overlap of two or more techniques in any work. Although some paintings appear to have been painted directly from life, they may also have been built up with careful final stages to heighten the tone and effect of colors, or to increase the element of detail. The work below has all the hallmarks of a

painting from life, although in fact it has been built up in a series of carefully planned stages. In this kind of transitional painting, it is usual to begin by blocking in major areas of tone and color, and then working into these with deeper glazes and more detail as the painting develops. The most important aspect of this process is that you add a new layer of paint only after the last layer is dry. A white ground retains the power and clarity of every color.

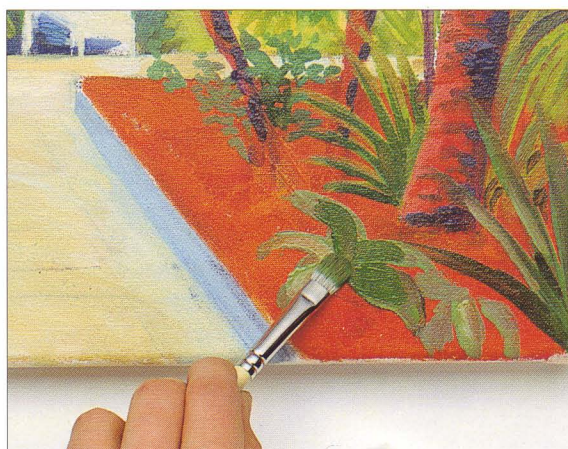
1 ▶ Make a light sketch of the composition in charcoal, working out the position of trees and plants. If the lines look too harsh, try brushing off the excess charcoal with a soft hair brush or a piece of doughy bread (see pp.40-41). Excess charcoal can muddy the paint if it is left lying on the surface of the canvas, so another way to protect the paint is to spray a surface coating of fixative over the charcoal outlines.



2 ▶ Block in the main areas of the painting with thin areas of pure, bright color using a large or medium-sized bristle brush. Leave these first layers to dry before adding new paint.



3 ▶ Once the first layers of thin paint are dry, deepen separate areas of color. Use a large synthetic wash brush to lay a thin, transparent glaze of Permanent Rose over the foreground area to deepen its tone. Mix a little oil painting medium into the Permanent Rose so that it can be manipulated more easily on the canvas. Use a clean, dry, soft hair brush to brush the glaze into a uniform consistency over the canvas.



4 ◀ Use a long filbert bristle brush to paint in branches and leaves. Use cool colors for areas in shadow and a transparent mix of Winsor Green for brighter details to create a sense of distance and capture the airy spaciousness of this conservatory.